

2.1.4 NURBS

NURBS modelling is exceptionally good at creating smooth, splined surfaces by using a minimum of points. NURBS is an acronym for non-uniform rational B-spline, the type of spline that defines a NURBS surface.

2.2 Creating Geometry

Geometry in 3ds Max is created by using either the Create menu on the main menu or the Geometry tab of the Create panel. This tab has a pull-down menu from which you can select different categories of objects to create. Most objects created are known as parametric objects. In other words, they use parameters to define the shape and form of the object. Only when an object is edited by using a modifier or modelling tool does it actually become a specific type of geometry.

2.3 Basic Primitives

The basic primitives are basic shapes, such as spheres, boxes, and cylinders. Each shape has its own controls to define the size of the object and amount of detail, as well as other parameters unique to the type of object.

Box: A box with definable detail. It is created by clicking on a viewport and dragging to define the base, and then dragging again to define the height.

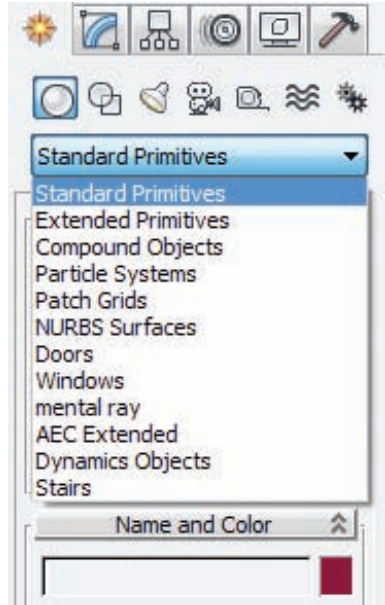
Sphere: A sphere shape with the geometry represented as latitudinal and longitudinal lines. A sphere is created by clicking in a viewport and dragging to the desired size.

Teapot: This object is the standard Utah teapot. Click and drag to set the size.

Cone: A cone is created by clicking on a viewport and dragging to define the base, and then dragging again to define the height.

Cylinder: A cylinder is created by clicking on a viewport and dragging to define the base, and then dragging again to define the height.

Torus: A doughnut shape. Created by clicking on the viewport to define the



The pull down menu of the Geometry tab in the Create Panel